

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	30 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-9263
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to user frustration and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

The team selected the problem of delays and manual overhead in the standard laptop procurement and configuration process. The intended user story is to streamline ordering so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Idea	Proposed Solution	Impact	Feasibility	Group
Automated Catalog Task Creation	Automatically create a catalog task after the laptop request is approved and assign it to the Hardware group.	High	High	Workflow Automation
Approval-Based Workflow Trigger	Use the Service Catalog approval status to trigger the laptop configuration workflow.	High	High	Workflow Automation
Automatic Hardware Assignment	Set the Assignment group to Hardware so configuration work reaches the responsible team without manual routing.	High	High	Task Assignment & Standardisation
Standard Laptop Service Catalog	Provide a Standard Laptop catalog item so users can place a structured request through Service Catalog.	High	High	User Request & Tracking
Automatic Task Description	Populate a consistent short description and description such as 'Laptop need to	Medium	High	Task Assignment & Standardisation

	Configured' for clear task handling.			
Request Status Visibility	Use the request and Requested Item records to track approval and downstream catalog-task status.	Medium	High	User Request & Tracking
Reduce Manual Procurement Steps	Replace repeated manual task creation and assignment with a Flow Designer workflow.	High	High	Workflow Automation
Improve Resource Utilisation	Automatically route configuration work to the Hardware team to support better task allocation.	Medium	High	Operational Efficiency
Error Reduction Through Standardisation	Use fixed workflow values and a standard catalog process to reduce omissions and inconsistent routing.	Medium	High	Task Assignment & Standardisation
Post-Arrival Configuration Readiness	Create the configuration task early so the laptop can be configured promptly upon arrival.	High	High	Operational Efficiency

Idea Grouping

Group	Ideas
Workflow Automation	Automated Catalog Task Creation; Approval-Based Workflow Trigger; Reduce Manual Procurement Steps
Task Assignment & Standardisation	Automatic Hardware Assignment; Automatic Task Description; Error Reduction Through Standardisation
User Request & Tracking	Standard Laptop Service Catalog; Request Status Visibility
Operational Efficiency	Improve Resource Utilisation; Post-Arrival Configuration Readiness

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

The ideas were prioritized based on their direct connection to the stated project objective, their ability to reduce manual intervention, and their role in creating a seamless standard laptop procurement and configuration workflow.

Priority	Idea	Reason for Priority
1	Automated Catalog Task Creation	Directly addresses the core requirement to create a task after approval and route it to Hardware.
2	Approval-Based Workflow Trigger	Ensures automation follows the approved-request condition described in the project workflow.

3	Automatic Hardware Assignment	Ensures the configuration task is assigned to the Hardware team without manual intervention.
4	Standard Laptop Service Catalog	Provides the structured entry point for placing the standard laptop request.
5	Request Status Visibility	Supports tracking from request and approval through the resulting catalog task.

Selected Concept

Implement an automated ServiceNow Flow Designer workflow for Standard Laptop requests. After the service request is approved, the flow creates a Catalog Task, sets the short description and description to indicate that the laptop needs configuration, and assigns the task to the Hardware group. The Standard Laptop service catalog item is linked to this flow so that requests can progress through a consistent automated process.

Expected outcome: timely configuration, reduced manual intervention and potential errors, improved task allocation, and better overall efficiency and user experience in IT procurement.